



Uintatherium

WIN-tah-THEE-ree-um



- **When** 45–40 million years ago (Paleogene)
- **Fossil location** N. America, Asia
- **Habitat** Plains
- **Length** 10 ft (3 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Uintatherium was another rhinoceros-like mammal, with a large, barrel-shaped body. Its skull was large and flat, but its brain was very small. On its head were three pairs of horns covered in skin, with the biggest horns at the back. Male *Uintatheriums* had larger horns than females, which suggests that they used them for display or for fighting other males. The animal's great weight and short legs suggest it usually moved slowly, although it may have been capable of short bursts of speed.

Phenacodus

fen-ACK-oh-duss



- **When** 55–45 million years ago (Paleogene)
- **Fossil location** N. America, Europe
- **Habitat** Grasslands, open woodlands
- **Length** 3 ft (1 m)
- **Diet** Grass

Like horses, *Phenacodus* had a skeleton well suited to running. In fact, experts once thought it was an ancestor of the horse. It had longer, more flexible legs than other primitive hoofed mammals and carried most of its weight on its three middle toes. Its large, squarish teeth were ideal for grinding up tough vegetation.

Phenacodus may have had a striped or spotted coat to blend in with woodland undergrowth and help it hide from predators.



Long, flexible tail

Five toes, each ending in a blunt claw

Mesoreodon

ME-zoe-REE-oh-don



- **When** 23 million years ago (Paleogene)
- **Fossil location** USA
- **Habitat** Deserts, prairies
- **Length** 3 ft (1 m)
- **Diet** Plants

Mesoreodon was a sheep-sized hoofed mammal with big eyes. One fossil was found with its voicebox preserved. Studies of the voicebox reveal that *Mesoreodon* could make loud, hooting sounds like modern howler monkeys—perhaps to frighten predators and warn members of its herd. It had sharp canine teeth that were probably used to defend against attacks,

or for display. The teeth at the back of the mouth had crescent-shaped edges, suitable for chewing low-growing plants.

